



Behind the Scoreboard

Sales Interviews



1. Accountability

To yourself. **Not your quota.**

Forget the excuses. Forget the fancy talk. Real accountability isn't just about hitting a number. It's the fire inside that makes you own every damn outcome. Good or bad, it's on you.

Performance Theater

You recite pipeline metrics. Anyone can do it. It's a shiny front you put up. Blame the market, bad leads, or competition when you miss. It's about **looking good, not stepping up.....CUT IT OUT.**

Your Operating System

This is your baseline. The standard you live by when no one's watching. It's your personal code: always pushing to get better. You own your results completely. You know your process inside and out. It's about **real results, born from cold, hard truth.**

You're gunning for a high-stakes sales leadership role. Your ability to truly own your wins and losses is everything. It's not about avoiding screw-ups. It's about how you hit back when they happen. We need leaders who rip problems apart, not point fingers. Leaders who learn, adapt, and drive their teams forward. Even when the market kicks you in the teeth. Your internal system shows how tough you are. It shows if you can truly lead when the heat is on.

We don't want perfect. We want real. We want the guts to face facts. This shows how you handle setbacks. It shows how you manage your team. And it shows how you lead when the chips are down. When every number counts.

So, tell me. When did you personally screw up and truly own it? What did you learn? How did you use that lesson when it really mattered?



2. Play Angry

I want candidates with **something to prove**. Not fake LinkedIn motivation. I mean the ones who play angry.

Forget the actual anger. This is about that raw, gut-level drive to win. To prove everyone wrong. To prove yourself right. It's that chip on your shoulder, that internal fire. The one that screams: "I refuse to lose. I won't settle." You're always pushing, always hungry.

High-stakes hiring managers sniff this out fast. They see it as real grit. You don't just show up; you dominate. You don't just hit targets; you smash them. This isn't desperation. It's a deep-seated hunger for excellence. You can't teach it, you either have it or you don't.

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If you don't have that edge in your gut, I can't manufacture it for you. Hiring managers feel it in the first 10 minutes.

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So, what does "playing angry" look like? It's the sales leader who just lost a massive deal. They don't wallow. They tear that failure apart, learn every lesson, and then hunt down the next, bigger win with a vengeance. It's the rep who gets five "no's." Instead of quitting, they see it as five steps closer to the "yes" they're gonna get. You take every punch, every challenge, and turn it into fuel for an even stronger comeback.

This isn't being a jerk; it's confidence. It comes from knowing you can overcome anything. It's not desperate; it's a cold, hard drive to win. You prepare obsessively. You know the market, the product, the customer inside and out. You're always getting better, beyond what anyone expects. You don't just do the work; you attack it. You refuse to be outdone. When things get tough, or quotas look impossible, the "angry player" doesn't just adapt. They find new angles, they hustle, they deliver.

Think of it as the ultimate competitive spirit. It's the leader who won't let their team coast. Not because they're mean, but because they believe in what that team can *really* do. You know your process. You have the fire to execute it perfectly, even when everything is on the line. We need to see that spark. That drive. The one that makes you not just good, but damn exceptional.

3. Honesty

You can't unf*ck a lie.

Honesty isn't just a nice-to-have. It's everything. The base of any real professional game, especially in sales leadership. Without it, you're building on sand. When we're hiring, we're not just checking skills. We're checking character. We need to know who you *really* are, especially when the heat's on.

A lie, no matter how small, is a giant red flag. It tells us you chose faking it over telling the truth. It shows you can't face ugly facts. Most of all, it screams that you can't be trusted when things get tough. That kills the deal. Every single time.

The fallout isn't just losing a job offer. In this business, word gets around. Your reputation takes a hit. Your network burns. You become poison in certain circles. It's a dumb, short-term play that screws you for good.

The Mistake

Two candidates this year lied about their past. One hid a blank spot, one hid getting fired. Both thought they could smooth it over.

The Cost

Managers loved them. But both offers got pulled on the spot. Once trust is gone, it's dead. No charm or talent brings it back.

So, how does honesty give you an edge? Because most people won't risk it. Resumes are polished. Stories are spun. Real talk stands out. Someone who can own their screw-ups, explain a career blip, or talk about challenges straight up? That shows guts. It shows you're not scared of reality. It shows you can handle messy situations with your cards on the table.

This means in an interview: Got a gap? Explain it. Got fired? Talk about what you learned. Made a huge mistake? Break it down. Don't hide. Don't dodge. Own your truth. Show us how you bounced back. We want to see how you deal with a punch, not how well you can paint over a bruise.

For sales leaders, trust is everything. Your team has to believe in you. Your clients have to trust your word. A leader who lies for a quick win will destroy confidence, fast. Faster than any deal you could close. It's not just about selling. It's about building real relationships. That starts with raw, unwavering honesty.



Don't be an idiot. No amount of charm brings trust back. Integrity is your most valuable asset.

4. Prospecting Yourself

The ATS is a blackhole. Treat your job search like you treat your territory.

Forget everything you've been told about "applying online" and "waiting to hear back." That's a passive, losing strategy. The Applicant Tracking System (ATS) isn't designed to find the best candidate; it's designed to filter out the most. It's a keyword gatekeeper, a digital bouncer that chucks 80% of resumes before a human ever sees them. Your meticulously crafted resume? It's just digital dust in a vast database, waiting for a keyword match that might never happen. This isn't about being seen; it's about being found by the right person, not some algorithm.

Hiring managers aren't looking at generic applications. They're drowning in them. What gets their attention? A direct, personalized message that shows you've done your homework, understand their pain, and can offer a solution. They respond to initiative, to proactivity, to someone who doesn't wait for permission. This is sales, pure and simple. You're the product, the company is the prospect, and you need to close the deal.



Ignore the "Apply" Button

"We'll review every application" is corporate speak for "good luck." It's a high-volume, low-conversion strategy that might make HR happy, but it won't land you the role. Don't waste your prime selling hours blindly clicking "apply." Use job boards to identify target companies and roles, then pivot to direct outreach. The online application is a last resort, not a first move. Relying on it is like waiting for inbound leads without ever making an outbound call.



Get the Data

Your goal is to find the actual decision-maker. This is the hiring manager, the VP of Sales, the Head of Revenue — not HR. Use tools like LinkedIn Sales Navigator, ZoomInfo, Hunter.io, or even just clever Google searches to find their direct email and, ideally, their personal cell phone number. Research their company, their recent wins, their challenges. Identify what keeps them up at night. This isn't stalking; it's smart prospecting. Your success hinges on having the right contact information for your target. Don't be afraid to dig.



Do What You Do Best

Sell. This is where you leverage your sales instincts. Craft a hyper-personalized message. Your goal isn't to ask for a job; it's to ask for a conversation. Lead with value. "I noticed X challenge your company is facing, and in my previous role at Y, I helped solve a similar issue by doing Z." Attach a concise, problem-solving-focused case study, not a generic resume. What NOT to say: "I'm looking for a job" or "Can you help me get an interview?" Frame it as an opportunity for them to gain insight or solve a problem. Be confident, concise, and compelling. This direct approach isn't just about cutting through the noise; it's about demonstrating your ability to prospect, identify needs, and close.

Why does this work? Because you're demonstrating the very skills they're trying to hire for. You're showing initiative, resourcefulness, personalization, and a direct approach to problem-solving. These are invaluable traits in any high-performing sales organization. Most people are too scared, too lazy, or too conventional to try it. That's your competitive advantage.

Common mistakes: sending generic emails, giving up after one attempt, attaching a massive resume without context, sounding desperate, or not doing enough research. This isn't a spray-and-pray approach; it's precision targeting. Think of it as an Account-Based Selling strategy for your own career. Build a target account list (companies), identify key contacts (hiring managers), and execute a multi-channel outreach strategy (email, LinkedIn, phone).



Your job search is your toughest sales territory. Close the deal on your career.

Stop applying. Start selling.